A striking passage illustrating this old-world religious attitude occurs in the famous Encyclical *Rerum Novarum* of Pope Leo XIII issued in May 1891. Continuing his argument dealing with the new industrial conditions, he says:

"To suffer and to endure, therefore, is the lot of humanity; let men try as they may, no strength and no artifice will ever succeed in banishing from human life the ills and troubles which beset it. If any there are who pretend differently—who hold out to a hard-pressed people freedom from pain and trouble, undisturbed repose and constant enjoyment—they cheat the people and impose upon them, and their lying promises will only make the evil worse than before. There is nothing more useful than to look at the world as it really is—and at the same time look elsewhere for a remedy to its troubles."

Further on we are told where this 'elsewhere' is:

"The things of the earth cannot be understood or valued rightly without taking into consideration the life to come, the life that will last for ever. . . . The great truth which we learn from Nature herself is also the grand Christian dogma on which religion rests as on its base—that when we have done with this present life then we shall really begin to live. God has not created us for the perishable and transitory things of the earth, but for things heavenly and everlasting; He has given us the world as a place of exile, and not as our true country. Money and the other things which men call good and desirable —we may have them in abundance or we may want them altogether; as far as eternal happiness is concerned, it is no matter. . . ."

This religious attitude is bound up with the world of long ago when the only possible escape from present misery was in the hope of a world to come. But though conditions changed and raised the human level in material prosperity beyond the wildest dreams of the past, the stranglehold of that past continued, the stress now being laid on certain vague, unmeasurable spiritual values. The Catholics look back to the twelfth and thirteenth centuries—the very period which is called the 'Dark Age' by others—as the Golden Age of Christianity, when saints flourished, and Christian rulers sallied forth to fight in the Crusades, and Gothic cathedrals grew up. That was the age, according to them "of true Christian democracy which was then realised under the control of the medieval guilds, more fully than it has ever been before or since." Muslims look back with longing to the "democracy of Islam" under the early Khalifs, and to their amazing career of victory.